INDAPAMIDE

Stroke prevention evidence

Hyponatraemia

CHEMICAL NAME 4-chloro-N-(2-methyl-2,3-dihydro-1H-indol-1-yl)-3-sulfamoylbenzamide
CLASS Thiazide-like diuretic
TRADE NAMES Natrilix · Natrilix SR · Lozol · Preterax (with perindopril)

THERAPEUTIC USES / INDICATIONS

- Hypertension (preferred thiazide-like diuretic in many guidelines).
- Secondary stroke prevention (with perindopril).
- Oedema in heart failure.

ADMINISTRATION

- **PO** once daily in the morning; SR tablets swallowed whole.

DOSAGES

- **Hypertension:** 2.5 mg once daily or 1.5 mg SR once daily.
- Higher doses increase side effects without more BP reduction.

PHARMACOKINETICS

- **Onset:** 1–2 h. **Duration:** 24 h.
- Highly lipid-soluble; metabolised in liver.
- Excreted in urine and faeces. **t½:** 14–18 h.

NURSING MANAGEMENT

- Monitor BP, Na^+, K^+ (especially elderly).
- Assess for confusion, cramps.
- Monitor uric acid and glucose.
- Fall precautions.

PHARMACODYNAMICS

- Inhibits **Na^+/Cl^- reabsorption** in cortical diluting segment.
- Direct vasodilator action; less metabolic disturbance at low dose.

SIDE & ADVERSE EFFECTS

SIDE EFFECTS (COMMON)

- Dizziness, headache.
- Fatigue.
- Rash.

ADVERSE EFFECTS (SERIOUS)

- Hyponatraemia and hypokalaemia.
- Hyperuricaemia; hyperglycaemia (less than HCTZ).
- QT prolongation (with hypokalaemia).
- Photosensitivity.

CONTRAINDICATIONS & CAUTIONS

- Severe renal impairment, hepatic encephalopathy.
- Hypokalaemia.
- Sulfonamide hypersensitivity.
- **Caution:** gout, diabetes, elderly.

KEY INTERACTIONS

- **Lithium:** toxicity.
- **QT-prolonging drugs:** torsades (with hypokalaemia).
- **Digoxin:** toxicity if hypokalaemic.

PATIENT EDUCATION

- Take every morning.
- Report confusion, cramps, weakness.
- Use sunscreen.
- Keep BP checks.

KEY POINTS

- Thiazide-like diuretic for hypertension.
- Watch sodium and potassium.
- 2.5 mg or 1.5 mg SR once daily.
- Stroke prevention with perindopril.

SOURCES CHECKED **[331]** Indapamide 2.5mg Tablets (UK SmPC) **[332]** Indapamide, oral (US label) **[333]** Indapamide, oral (US label, Preferred Pharmaceuticals Inc)
Full references p. 432–457